CORE FALSE BELIEF #16 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

“Something terrible is going to happen.”

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Where it often comes from

A sense of coming doom often follows a sudden shock, such as an unexpected death, diagnosis, or accident, which teaches the mind that disaster can strike without warning. It can also grow in homes where parents were constantly worried, or where something bad really did happen often. Worry can feel like protection, as if expecting the worst could prevent it.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus told His followers not to worry about tomorrow, because each day has enough trouble of its own. Paul urged believers to bring every anxious thought to God in prayer with thanksgiving, and promised that God’s peace would guard their hearts and minds. The psalmist describes a person who does not fear bad news because his heart is steady, trusting in the Lord. Worry cannot add a single hour to life. God does not ask us to pretend bad things never happen; He asks us to trust Him with tomorrow.

> *“Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own”* (Matthew 6:34).

Also see

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

> “He does not fear bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD” (Psalm 112:7).

> “Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?” (Matthew 6:27).

> “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control” (2 Timothy 1:7).

Common self-statements

- I just know something bad is coming.
- If I stop worrying, it will happen.
- Every phone call might be bad news.
- Things are too good; something will go wrong.
- I need to be prepared for the worst.
- I can’t shake this feeling of dread.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting disaster without evidence.
- Catastrophizing: Jumping from a small worry to the worst possible outcome.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing danger is coming because I feel dread.
- Magical thinking: Believing my worry somehow prevents bad things.

Challenging questions

- What evidence do I have that something terrible is about to happen?

- How many times have I felt this dread and nothing happened?
- Does my worrying actually prevent anything?
- If something hard did happen, how might God help me through it?
- What does Jesus say about tomorrow?
- What can I do today instead of worrying about tomorrow?

Truth summary

> Hard things can happen, and I cannot prevent every one. But this feeling of dread is not a prophecy, and worry does not protect me. God holds tomorrow. I can bring my fears to Him, live today, and trust Him to help me with whatever comes.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Fear Is a Liar — Zach Williams
Examine fear-driven accusations rather than treating them as reliable truth.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Something terrible is going to happen"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something terrible is going to happen." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What evidence says something terrible is coming?
- ☐ How often has this dread come true?
- ☐ Does worrying prevent anything?
- ☐ How might God help me if something hard happened?
- ☐ What does Jesus say about tomorrow?
- ☐ What can I do today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Tomorrow will take care of itself.
- ☐ God's peace can guard my heart and mind.
- ☐ Dread is a feeling, not a prediction.
- ☐ Worry cannot add an hour to my life.
- ☐ God holds my future.
- ☐ I can live today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 6:34**
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:6–7**
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Psalm 112:7**
  "He does not fear bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Fears and outcomes: Each day, write down any fear about something terrible happening. A week later, note whether it happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 6:34 becomes: "James can write: "I don't have to carry tomorrow today. God will be with me when it comes.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Test your predictions. Keep a list of the bad things you predict for two weeks. At the end, count how many actually happened.
- [ ] Set a worry time. Give yourself 15 minutes a day to write worries and pray over them. Outside that time, gently postpone worry.
- [ ] Pray it through. When dread rises, pray Philippians 4:6–7 aloud, naming each fear and thanking God for one thing.
- [ ] Get help for constant dread. If dread is constant or comes with panic attacks, talk with a doctor or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something terrible is going to happen": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A fear that did not come true
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something terrible is going to happen.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am so often afraid that something terrible is coming. Thank You that You hold tomorrow. I give You my fears today. Guard my heart and mind with Your peace, and help me live this day with You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.